



Crisis Committee

STUDY GUIDE

JASMUN 2026



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1. LETTER FROM THE CHAIRBOARD

Hello, ¡hola!, nǐ hǎo, as the crisis team we would like to warmly welcome you in this year's crisis committee. We hope that you had an amazing summer and we can't wait to meet you all at the conference. The crisis team has been working really hard for these past months to prepare this committee for you with hopes that it will become a fun and engaging experience, filled with vivid debates and thoughtful solutions. Crisis is arguably the most dynamic and fast-paced committee in the MUN world, so be prepared for unexpected plot-twists full of chaos and disarray. But don't worry your lovely chairs and crisis writers would do their best to navigate you through this madness. The crisis committee might be quite challenging for a first-timer due to unusual ROP and the dynamic flow of the debate, therefore we strongly encourage you to read through the ROP that is attached in this document.

2. INTRODUCTION TO THE COMMITTEE

As you may know, the Crisis Committee is a little different from other committees. To completely grasp this committee it is important to understand its purpose and mechanics. The Crisis Committee is a special UN body created to effectively deal with sudden emergencies that pose a threat to global security. Due to its uniqueness the Crisis Committee holds special powers and has a slightly different ROP. First and foremost, in a crisis there are no static topics that would be discussed during the conference. Instead your task as delegates is to provide solutions to an ongoing situation. Every now and then new facts and events will come out publicly in the form of “Crisis Updates”. These updates will be drafted by crisis writers and will create completely new scenarios, so be prepared to change your strategies and come up with new solutions on the spot.

Secondly, in contrast to other committees, where solutions in the resolution are written in the form of recommendations, CC allows delegates to use operative verbs (known from the Security Council), such as, “urges” or “condemns”.

Furthermore, unlike other committees we won’t be writing multiple resolutions. Instead we will use Directives and Secret Directives, which are shorter, and more pragmatic documents, which allow us to quickly respond to the crisis. In order to fully understand their purpose and mechanics we strongly advise you to read through sections dedicated to them in the ROP. If at any stage you would feel confused about the rules feel free to contact the chairboard or crisis writers.

3. HOW TO PREPARE

One of many perks of being a delegate in the Crisis Committee is that it doesn’t require as extensive preparation as other committees. Nonetheless, you still need to put a little effort in order to ensure that the debate will run smoothly, so if you’ve expected that you won’t need to prepare at all, we are terribly sorry ;). Okay, so what should you actually do in order to prepare?

Firstly, we once again strongly recommend you read the ROP thoroughly!! Our committee has a unique ROP that is completely different from the ROP of the rest of the chambers at Jasmun or CCs at other MUN conferences. Ergo, even if it's not your first time being a delegate of the Crisis Committee, we still advise you to look through it.

Secondly, as soon as you receive a country that you will represent, please research the overall geopolitical situation of that country. Perhaps you can check how your country reacted to previous crises, as it might help you figure out the general attitude of the citizens and eventually make your proposed solutions more realistic. Fortunately for you guys, our lovely crisis writers decided to make your task easier by providing small insights into a situation in each country. However, if you want to be kings of the jungle and fight for the awards, we advise you to dig a bit deeper.

The last thing that we will ask you to do might sound a bit controversial, and we are totally aware of it, but please don't get angry, and let us explain. Getting to the point, we would like to kindly ask you to write a short document called a Crisis Statement, which would outline the internal situation in your country, as well as its relations with other states. We know that one of the main benefits of many crisis committees is that delegates don't need to write position papers or any other documents, but please believe us that we added this change for your own good. By doing this, we won't need to entertain any policy statements, which saves lots of time and allows us to move strictly to the discussion on possible solutions. Additionally, writing this kind of document will help you develop more realistic and effective ideas, as you will be able to understand your country's standings. On the following page, you can find the full guide, which describes how to write this document.

We would also like to reassure you that if you find any troubles or questions during the preparation process, you're more than welcome to send us a message, and we would be happy to support you.

4. RULES OF PROCEDURE

Crisis Statement

Dear delegates, in this crisis you will be required to write a Crisis Statement. We know that the idea of writing a document for Crisis might seem a little bit controversial, but HEAR US OUT. The two main goals of it are: making you more

prepared prior to the conference, which will result in you having knowledge about the state/actor you are representing and hence, facilitating the decision-making process during Crisis (the debate will be intense, so the decisions ought to be fast), and saving time the policy statements would consume (we will need that time, believe us). Voila, now let's proceed to the requirements which are easy, yet accurate:

The crisis statement must meet the following formal requirements:

- LENGTH AROUND 1 PAGE,
- font: Times New Roman,
- font size: 12,
- double line spacing/interline,
- it should concern:
 - state's internal situation (ruling party, government, economics, military, willingness to get involved into potential tensions/conflicts),
 - state's relations with the other countries in the committee,
 - state's involvement and strategic interests in the region of Latin and Central America (trade, reaction to crises, alliances, treaties),
- security policy,
- counter-terrorism,
- public health measures,
- migration policy.

Remember, that the goal of Crisis Statement is to help you prepare for the debate. It means that understanding the policy of your country is more important than producing an impeccable document. Keep that in mind, and make an extensive and fruitful research, which means NOT USING AI TO WRITE THE CS. Plagiarism, AI-generated content, or heavily automated writing may result in punishments determined by the Chairboard and lost eligibility for the awards.

Directives

Directives are the primary operational documents used within the committee to respond to crisis situations, coordinate actions, and influence the development of events. A directive may include military operations, intelligence cooperation, sanctions, emergency health measures, evacuations, cyber responses, or any other action relevant to the crisis. Directives may be written by individual delegates or groups of delegates and may involve

cooperation between states, agencies, or both. Once introduced and passed by the committee, a directive becomes immediately active and may directly affect future crisis updates and committee developments. Instead of a resolution, the committee produces a list of passed directives that influenced the situation in Crisis.

Secret Directives

Secret directives are confidential operational instructions submitted privately to the Chairboard through a page note. Unlike normal directives, their contents are not revealed to the rest of the committee unless decided otherwise by the Chairboard. Secret Directives should specify the type of action, place, scale, and other important information that would help the Chairboard understand it. The success, failure, or consequences of a secret directive are determined solely by the Crisis Staff and Chairboard. Delegates should be aware that secret directives may produce unexpected outcomes and may influence future crisis updates without public explanation. There is a limit of 2 Secret Directives sent by a given delegate in one committee session.

Amendments

Amendments are formal changes proposed to an already introduced directive. Their purpose is to revise, clarify, remove, or expand specific parts of a directive before final voting takes place. Amendments allow delegates to negotiate compromises, correct problematic wording, or alter the direction of a directive without rewriting the entire document.

Once an amendment has been passed or rejected, the committee proceeds according to the updated or original version of the directive. A maximum of three amendment motions may be introduced regarding the same directive. Once implemented, amendments may no longer be changed, thus there are no Second-Degree Amendments.

Friendly Amendments

Friendly amendments are amendments intended to revise a directive while maintaining its original sense and overall purpose. They are generally used to clarify wording, improve practicality, correct technical issues, or add neutral

clauses that do not significantly alter the intent of the proposal. Friendly amendments are usually supported by the sponsors of the original directive and are treated as cooperative revisions rather than hostile modifications. Debate on a friendly amendment includes a 30 s long speech in favor (the time may vary due to time constraints), and passes automatically under the discretion of the Chairboard.

Unfriendly Amendments

Unfriendly amendments are amendments that substantially change the meaning, direction, or consequences of a directive. They may add controversial clauses, remove key operational elements, alter the political objective of the proposal, or introduce actions not supported by the original sponsors. Unlike friendly amendments, unfriendly amendments are generally introduced in opposition to the original directive or as an attempt to redirect committee action. The debate upon the unfriendly amendments entails:

- 1 minute 30 second speech in favor (with 3 POIs + extensions),
- 3 minute long time in favor,
- 3 minute long time against,

There are no Second-Degree amendments.

Follow-Ups

Follow-ups are additional questions or short statements asked after a POI response. They are intended to clarify unclear answers, challenge inconsistencies, or continue a relevant line of questioning connected to the original POI. A maximum of two follow-ups may be asked regarding the same POI exchange. Follow-ups may also take the form of short statements if permitted by the Chair. Delegates are expected to remain concise and avoid transforming follow-ups into speeches or personal attacks. After the second follow-up there will be no response allowed from the answering delegate, therefore it should not be a question.

Points

Points are tools which may be used by Delegates to engage in debate with other members, inquire about the technicalities of a debate, or ensure that discussions proceed orderly. Delegates may raise a point during debates, provided that it does not interrupt a voting procedure, the chair, or fellow participants speaking. They may do so by raising their placard and stating, once recognised either by the

Chairboard or the President of the General Assembly, the name of the point and its nature (i.e. Point of Order. Is it in order...?). The Chairboard shall take action required by the Points before recognising any Motions or Speakers. The following points are presented in order from most to least disruptive and should be recognised in that way.

Point of Personal Privilege

A Point of Personal Privilege may be raised if a Delegate is experiencing discomfort that prevents him from fully partaking in the debates. For instance, it may be used by Delegates to ask for permission to leave the room or raise issues regarding either the audibility or visibility of crucial aspects concerning the debate on the floor. In case of such audibility or visibility issues, this is the only Point that may interrupt the speaker currently on the floor. However it is advised for Delegates to refrain from doing so in non-urgent situations.

Point of Order

A Point of Order may be raised by a Delegate if they believe the Rules of Procedure were or are being violated, ignored, or misinterpreted. Such a point is a direct referral, meaning it can only refer to a situation that has just occurred. Additionally, it is not to be debated on the floor. In case such a point is raised, the Chair Board must rule whether any violation took place and ensure that the proceedings continue according to the Rules. If the Delegate objects to the Chair Board's decision they have the right to appeal it through the Motion to Appeal (see: Motion to Appeal). Subsequently, the Secretary-General, President of the General Assembly, or Head of Academics will determine whether the Chair Board's decision was appropriate

Right of Reply

A or Right of Reply may be raised if the Delegate feels that the sovereignty or territorial integrity of their country is being threatened in a speech given on the floor, when they feel offended by another delegation's factually incorrect statement made about their country's culture and traditions. The acceptance of this point is subject to a decision of the Chair Board, but should any ambiguities arise, the President of the General assembly or Head of Academics can be consulted. This point cannot interrupt a speech and should be raised after the floor is yielded. Rights of Reply cannot be raised to Points or Motions. If the Chair board accepts the Right of Reply,

the Delegate subject to the Point is to provide a formal apology. The Chairboard is to decide whether they deem the apology sufficient, or if it needs to be rephrased or repeated. When a Delegate refuses to give a formal apology or rephrase an unsatisfactory one, they are subject to a punishment. Additionally, that Delegate's respective Ambassador will be called for to consult with the Delegate and offer an apology in their stead.

Point of Parliamentary Inquiry

A Point of Parliamentary Inquiry may be raised if the Delegate is unsure about the interpretation of the Rules of Procedure during the debates. The Chairpersons are to provide the Delegate with a clear answer to their inquiry. If the Chairpersons are unable to answer, the Secretariat ought to be consulted.

Point of Information

Delegate. The Delegate may state that they are either "Open" or "Closed" to POIs. If they choose the latter, there will be no POIs entertained unless an appropriate motion is approved (see: Motion to Open the Delegate to POIs). In case the Delegate is "Open", the Chairboard shall ask Delegates present "Is there any delegation wishing to ask POI?". Once the speaking Delegate states their openness or refusal to accept POIs and all other Points are ruled, the Chairs will select the default number of them to be asked.

Motions

Motion to Appeal

This Motion should be raised by a Delegate who feels a decision made by the Chairpersons violates the Rules of Procedure, or believes the Chairperson's decision is unfair. The Chairboard cannot overrule such a Motion. After the Motion to Appeal is raised, the Chairs are to conduct an obligatory voting procedure on the matter. If at least 50% of the present Delegate and Observers support the Motion, the President of the General Assembly or Head of Academics should be called to settle the appealed case. In case a Chairboard's decision is appealed to successfully, its effects are longer binding. The decision of the PGA or the Head of Academics are final.

Motion to Explain the Vote

This Motion can be raised by any Delegate who feels another Delegate's vote was not in compliance with their country's policy, or if they have doubts regarding the cause for their vote. It is to be considered by the Chair Board or Secretariat, and if passed under their discretion, obliges the concerned Delegate to explain and justify their vote. There are no Points of Information, objections or seconds to the explanation.

Motion to Change the Vote

This Motion can be raised immediately after a response to the Motion to Explain the Vote has been provided. If the provided response has been deemed unsatisfactory their vote may be changed. This motion passes under the discretion of the Chair Board or the Secretariat.

Motion to Split the House

This Motion may be raised if a clause, amendment, or draft resolution does not pass due to a significant number of abstentions. This motion requires a simple majority to pass. However, it may be automatically failed under the discretion of the Chair Board or the President of the General Assembly. Once adopted, it entails another voting procedure by roll call, in which abstaining is not possible for anyone with voting rights.

Motion for a Follow-Up

This Motion may be raised by any Delegate who raised a Point of Information and received an answer from the Speaker on the Floor. The Decision upon passing this Motion is subject to the decision of the Chairboard. If passed, it has to be a brief follow-up question to the matter being currently discussed. Significantly, it should not be formulated in the form of a statement. The speaker may then answer such questions in the same manner as Points of Information are addressed (it must be noted that the speaker on the floor must always have the final say). No more than one Motion for a Follow-Up may be raised by one Delegate during a POI session. It is advised for the Chairboard to strictly distribute the Follow-ups, minding the time constraints. Only 2 Follow-ups can be granted to a Speaker on the Floor. The

Chairboard reserves the right to interrupt any Follow-up if it proves to be a statement, has no substantive input into the proceedings of the debate, or has been already asked and answered.

Motion to Open the Delegate to Points of Information

This Motion may be raised if a Delegate states that they are "closed" to Points of Information (POIs). It requires an approval from the Chairboard or the President of the General Assembly, and two seconds to pass. It allows for POIs to be asked to the Delegate who is subject to the motion. If the Delegate still refuses to respond, they may be subject to punishments under the discretion of the Chairboard or the President of the General Assembly.

Motion to Extend the Number of POIs

This Motion may be raised only once the default number of POIs has been exhausted and the Floor is declared by the Chairboard open to any motions. It allows for an extension of the number of POIs asked to the current Speaker on the Floor. The maximum extension is 5 additional POIs. However, the Chairboard should be advised to refrain from recognising too many POIs due to time constraints. This Motion passes automatically under the discretion of the Chairboard. The Chairboard reserves the right to amend the number of additional POIs suggested by the Delegate raising the Motion.

Motion to Let the Delegate Finish

This Motion may be raised once the Speaker on the Floor has exhausted the time provided, and yet has not concluded. It cannot be raised by the Speaker themselves and passes automatically under the discretion of the Chairboard. It provides the Speaker with additional 20 seconds to conclude. However, this extension should not be overused. It is preferable to raise a Motion to Change the Time per Speaker beforehand, rather than Motion to Let the Delegate Finish.

Motion to Provide/Cite the Source

This Motion may be raised by a Delegate who wishes to know the source of any fact another Delegate has cited in their speech. It is adopted under the discretion of the Chair Board, and if passed, obliges the Delegate that stated a concerned fact to provide the source for the whole committee within 20 minutes, in the form stated by the Chair Board. If the source is not considered valid by the Chair Board, the Delegate may be punished according to the Code of Conduct. Significantly, the Motion to Cite a Source cannot be raised to a stated non-factual opinion.

Motion to Consult the Whole

The default Flow of the Debate is Open Debate. It may however be interrupted by a raised Motion to Consult the Whole. For it to be adopted it requires a simple majority and needs to be approved by the Chairboard. The Delegate raising the motion must specify a topic, or an operative clause they want to focus on. It is advised for the Chairboard to allow only for very specific Motions to Consult a Whole. Once passed, every Delegate in alphabetical order is given 60 seconds to deliver a brief statement on the provided topic. No POIs are allowed to give speeches in this format. The Motion to Consult the Whole may not be terminated, unless an appropriate motion (see: 6.11) has been unanimously approved by the Committee (so as to give every Delegate a chance to speak). Only one Consultation of the Whole in a row may be introduced, meaning that following its end the Committee must proceed with Open Debate. This however remains amendable under the discretion of the Chairboard in urgent situations. A Motion to Consult the Whole may only be raised once the Floor is declared open to any motions.

Motion to Terminate the Lobbying

This Motion may be raised when a Delegate believes the Moderated Caucus or Lobbying Time the Committee is currently in is no longer productive. This Motion requires a simple majority for it to be adopted.

Motion to Extend the Time in Favor/Against or Lobbying

This Motion may be raised by a Delegate when the time allocated for the Moderated Caucus, Lobbying Time, or Time in Favor/Against has elapsed. When raising the motion the Delegate has to state the duration of the extension. The maximum possible extension is by half of the initial time. It requires a simple majority to pass and is subject to Chairboard's approval. The Consultation of the Whole may not be extended.

Motion to Move Into Time Against

This Motion may be raised during the time in favor of the resolution/amendment. It cannot however interrupt the current Speaker and may be raised only once the POI discussed on the Floor has been answered. It requires a simple majority to pass and has to be approved by the Chairboard. It is advised that the Chairboard refrain from approving this Motion if the ongoing debate in favor of the Resolution is substantive. Once adopted the time in favor elapses and the Delegate who raised the motion may approach the Floor and deliver a speech against.

Motion to Table an Amendment/Directive

This Motion can be raised by a Delegate at any point during the debate regarding an amendment/directive. It is subject only to objections. If there are no objections the motion passes and the amendment/directive fails before moving to the voting procedure. The Chairboard reserves the right to conduct voting by acclamation to confirm that the motion has passed.

Motion to Vote by Roll Call

This Motion can be raised when the Committee is moving into voting procedures, or when the results of a vote conducted by acclamation are unclear. It requires a simple majority and Chairboard's approval to pass. If adopted, the Chairboard has to conduct a vote by roll call. Mind you, this Motion can be adopted while voting upon a Draft Resolution, since its default voting procedure is already a roll call.

Motion to Censor

This Motion may be raised by any Delegate who feels another participant of the debates has somehow violated the Rules of Procedure, or is consistently disrupting the flow of the debates. The motion needs at least two seconds to be considered by the Secretariat. If censored, the Delegate is banned from participating in the debates for an amount of time decided by the Chairs not exceeding 30 minutes; this, however, does not curb their ability to vote. If there is a need to censor a Delegate more than once during a single committee session, or if there is a need to censor them three times during the day, it is recommended the Chair Board contact the Secretariat for them to take further disciplinary measures. Any Censored Delegate may raise the Motion to Appeal if they consider the Chairboard's decision unfair.

Motion to Introduce a Directive or Amendment

A motion to introduce a directive or amendment is the formal procedure through which delegates present their proposal to the committee for debate. In order for it to be accepted by the Chairboard, the directive/amendment has to be posted on the document shared within the committee, and decided to be relevant to the topic after being read out by the sponsor. Once accepted by the Chair, the directive or amendment is formally introduced and debate begins according to committee procedure. The sponsor of the proposal delivers a speech in favor presenting the content and purpose of the document before the committee enters formal debate. Only a maximum of three amendments can be introduced to a given directive.

Motion for a Follow-Up

Follow-ups are additional questions or short statements asked after a Point Of Information (POI) response. They are intended to clarify unclear answers, challenge inconsistencies, or continue a relevant line of questioning connected to the original POI. A maximum of two follow-ups may be asked regarding the same POI exchange. Follow-ups may also take the form of short statements if permitted by the Chair. Delegates are expected to remain concise and avoid transforming follow-ups into speeches or personal attacks. After the second follow-up there will be no response allowed from the answering delegate, therefore it should not be a question.

Motion to Move to the Voting Procedure

A motion to move to the voting procedure is raised when delegates believe debate on a directive or amendment has been sufficiently exhausted and the committee is ready to vote. If accepted by the Chair, formal debate immediately ends and the committee proceeds into voting procedure, however, it can only be raised during the time against the amendment/directive. During voting procedure, delegates may no longer deliver speeches, ask POIs, or introduce additional debate unless specifically permitted by the Chairboard. For a directive or amendment to pass, a simple majority is required. Once passed, the directive or amendment is immediately implemented and becomes final.

Motion to Move to the Time Against the Directive/Amendment

It is a motion raised by a delegate when they feel like the debate in favor of a given directive or amendment is not necessary, fruitful, or does not lead anywhere. This motion can be raised after a delegate finishes their speech in the time in favor, and there are no more delegates wishing to speak. In order for it to pass, it needs the chairboard's approval, at least 2 seconds and no objections. This motion is not voted upon. After it passes, the committee automatically proceeds to time against a given directive or amendment.

Motion to Extend the Time In Favor/Against/of an Unmoderated Caucus

It is a motion raised by a delegate when they feel like the time of the debate in favor, against a given directive or amendment, or during the Unmoderated Caucus is too short and it requires extension. This motion can be raised after the time in favor/against/of an Unmoderated Caucus elapses and requires a simple majority (as well as the Chairboard's approval) to pass. The time can be extended by no more than half of the original time. Once the motion passes, the committee automatically continues the debate in the previous format.

5. FLOW OF THE DEBATE

Crisis Update

The committee will operate under a dynamic crisis format combining formal debate, rapid procedural motions, and continuous crisis intervention. Debate may be interrupted at any moment by crisis updates delivered by the Crisis Staff. Following each update, delegates will be expected to react immediately through speeches, negotiations, directives, amendments, and procedural motions.

Unmoderated Caucus

Delegates may motion for an unmoderated caucus with a maximum duration of 15 minutes. During this time, formal debate is suspended, allowing delegates to negotiate, form alliances, draft directives, discuss amendments, and coordinate responses informally. The Chair reserves the right to reduce the requested duration to preserve committee flow. The Unmoderated Caucus can be extended by a maximum of half of the original time, after a Motion to Extend the Time of an Unmoderated Caucus passes.

Introduction of Directives

When delegates wish to introduce a directive, a Motion to Introduce a Directive must be raised. The delegate posts the directive on the shared document and reads it out in the committee. Following the introduction of a directive, the committee proceeds into formal debate. A speech in favour is delivered for 2 minutes and 30 seconds, followed by maximum 3 Points of Information (the number of POIs may be extended after a Motion to Extend the Number of POIs is raised).

Time in Favour of the Directive

After the speech in favor, the committee proceeds to the time in favor of a directive, which is in the form of a Moderated Caucus with a duration of 5 minutes. During this stage, delegates may also motion:

- to move directly into time against,
- or to extend debate time by 50%.

Time Against of the Directive

Afterward, the committee proceeds into time against for 5 minutes, during which delegates may speak against the directive and present objections, criticisms, or concerns regarding its implementation.

Friendly Amendments

Delegates may motion to introduce a friendly amendment to a directive or clause. Its goal is to revise the clause while maintaining its original sense. A delegate delivers a 30 second long speech and receives no POIs. A friendly amendment passes under the discretion of the Chairboard.

Unfriendly Amendments

Delegates may also motion to introduce an unfriendly amendment. The amendment's goal is to rewrite, strike out, add, or revise the text while changing its original sense.

Debate on an unfriendly amendment proceeds as follows:

- 1 minute 30 seconds speech in favour with POIs,
- 3 minutes of time in favor,
- 3 minutes of time against.
- Voting procedure (simple majority is needed)

Only three amendment motions regarding the same clause or directive may be introduced.

Voting Procedure

Once debate concludes, delegates may motion to move into voting procedure. The committee votes on the final (amended) version of the directive. It needs a simple majority to pass. Once passed, directives and amendments become final and may no longer be altered. Moreover, they immediately influence the situation in the crisis.

6. CASE STUDIES

Haiti

It is no secret that Haiti is known as a fallen country, mainly because of the everyday gang aggression, extreme poverty and lack of any living conditions. The Haitian government was struggling since the day it was formed in 1804 as France granted Haitian independence under the condition that the country pays 150 million francs. This greatly affected the development of Haiti, along with many internal conflicts and authoritarian presidents, such as Francois and Jean-Claude Duvalier. In 2021 the Haitian president Jovenel Moise was assassinated, and since then no new president was elected. Now the prime minister, Ariel Henry is in power. In the years that followed the coup of the last president gangs rose to power, with over 200 armed gangs operating in the whole country. According to Transparency International Haiti was 172nd of 180 countries on the 2023 ranking of Corruption Perception Index. Haiti enjoys rather good relations with Brazil, India, USA, Canada, Columbia and Mexico, with all of those countries lending help to Haitians. In 2025 Guatemalan forces were also sent as a measure of combating Haitian gangs. Additionally Haiti has created strong, legal and illegal trading ties with Jamaica.

Belize

While the country's internal situation remains relatively stable, Belizean relation with Guatemala remains tense since 2018 due to unresolved border dispute, with deep historical roots being among the causes, as well as recent Guatemalan intrusions upon Belizean territory. Yet Belize's relation with its neighbours such as Mexico and Panama remain positive. The latter also hosts the Chinese embassy to Belize, as the relationship between these two is rough. The main reason being the fact that Belize is one of the few countries recognizing Taiwan as the righteous government of China. Historically Belize's relationship with the USA was close, and focused on trade as well as defeating crime, yet the recent situation in Venezuela has cast a shadow over this relation, as Belize strongly supports Venezuela, and calls for a UN supported resolution of the issues there. As a part of the Commonwealth Belize enjoys a strong and stable relation with the UK. The European Union, including France has been a supportive ally as well, with Belize receiving contributions from the European Development Fund since 1982.

Useful links:

<https://en.unav.edu/web/global-affairs/detalle/-/blogs/comienza-la-recta-final-del-diferendo-territorial-entre-guatemala-y-belice-3>

<https://bco.gov.bz/>

China

Chinese internal politics remain focused on heavy technological and industrial development. At the same time the government struggles against activists leads to various human right infringements. The recent Ethnic Unity Law (introduced on 1st of July 2026) is meant to suppress national minorities such as Uyghurs and Tibetans. After the enactment of the law a Tibetan man self-immolated in front of UN headquarters in New York as a sign of protest. Additionally there have been arrests made on democratic Hong Kong activists commemorating the events on Tiananmen Square. Lastly, Chinese focus is on recent floods in Tibet and Nepal, as Chinese citizens were involved in the cataclysm. Externally China remains focused on tightening relations with Russia, with the project of the gas pipeline Power of Siberia 2 being proof of one of best times in relations between these two countries. As members of BRICS China also maintains positive relations with Brazil, who, while did not join the Belt and Road Initiative, is supportive of China and the "One China" policy. While China collaborates with Brazil its relationships with other countries of the region remain complicated. Some countries such as Haiti and Belize recognize Taiwan as the rightful ruler of the territory of China. Other relations like the one with Panama deteriorated due to Panama's ruling of Chinese company's concussion located near Panama Canal as illegitimate. Another uncertain relation may be the one of Venezuela, as China strongly supported Maduro, who paid multiple diplomatic visits to the PRC.

Useful links:

<https://www.cfr.org/articles/who-controls-panama-canal>

Panama

Panama's internal situation remains focused on the Panama Canal. The recent events connected to Chinese company's CK Hutchison Holdings concession on two ports and the low water levels caused by the El Nino turn the

international attention towards the Panama Canal. The US aims to regain control of the territory, which causes tension as Panama does not consider such an option. Additionally Panama decided to withdraw from the Belt and Road Initiative, which in turn affects its relation with China. Panama also remains focused on the matter of migrants, as thousands are crossing the Darien Gap in order to get to Columbia after facing deportation from the US. This allows human trafficking and illegal migration with many people dying as a result of the dangerous journey. A big part of migrants come from Venezuela, towards which Panama holds a stern position - a democratic election should be held. Panama maintains positive relations with other countries of the region such as Belize and Haiti with Panama pushing for a new force of 5500 to be sent to Haiti as a measure of combating gang activities. Relations with Nicaragua remain tense as Panama recalled its ambassador due to the co-president Ortega declaring no more elections should be held in Nicaragua. Panama enjoys good, mostly focused on trade, relations with the UK and France.

Useful links:

<https://www.cfr.org/articles/who-controls-panama-canal>

Venezuela

After the change of power on the 3 of January 2026 Delcy Rodriguez assumed power as a leader of the provisional government. Since those events Venezuela has been heavily dependent on the US, with the countries recently striking a deal for 65 billion barrels of Venezuelan oil. While the deal does bring Venezuela profits, the US is in control of 55% of the 100 year concession for oil extraction. Meanwhile China deems the US actions as illegitimate and is trying to counteract the US control over Venezuela, while stressing the importance of a peaceful approach. After the change of government in Venezuela the relationship with Russia suffered, as the US influence became stronger. Additionally many countries expressed condemnation for US actions including: Canada, Mexico, Guatemala and France. Belize expressed its hopes for a UN led, peaceful, democratic transition and Panama underlined the importance of democratic elections. Relation with the UK remains uncertain as it holds major reservoirs of frozen Venezuelan gold assets, which are to be transported to the US Treasury.

Canada

Canada is one of the most stable democracies in current times. It shares good relations with multiple European Countries, especially with the UK and France. Canada has historically been a very close ally with the UK, and the latter hosts its biggest foreign military base in Canada. At the same time France and Canada share cultural ties, goals and policies, such as the one directed at aiding Haiti. On the other hand Canadian relation with the United States remains tense due to threats of US-lead invasion as well as the disagreement on the issues of military intervention in Venezuela as well as the war in Iran. While Canada's relation with India has suffered due to disagreement about the 2020 farmer protests (which in turn caused the 2023-2025 diplomatic row between the two countries) it is improving (albeit slowly), mainly due to the freshly agreed upon, 10 year, nuclear deal. While Canada aims to maintain good relations with Mexico and countries of Central America, this is not always a possibility. For example due to Guatemalan president Alejandro Giammattei's corruptive behaviour sanctions had to be imposed on specific individuals in the country or sanctions imposed on individuals connected to Nicaraguan president Daniel Ortega. Yet Canada supports countries in the region such as Belize (the ACCBP initiative). Canada also maintains positive relations with bigger powers of the region such as Mexico and Brazil.

USA

The United States of America, known as one of the most powerful nations, and is the second biggest owner of nuclear weapons after Russia. The US also is the country with the highest GDP (32.38 trillion dollars), having immense influence and power. The US is currently involved in a conflict in Iran and works to disarm Hamas.

The Trump administration also began to strike vessels in the Caribbean and eastern pacific in last September claiming to be in a war with what they called „narco-terrorists” operating out of Latin America. Those actions sparked a debate about the legality of this operation because there was no definitive evidence that the boats were, in fact, involved with drug-trafficking. The US made also other attempts at minimising drug trafficking such as helping the Mexican security to kill Nemesio Rubén Oseguera Cervantes, known also as „El Mencho”, the leader of the most powerful Mexican trafficking organisations, Jalisco New Generation Cartel,

responsible for distributing a big amount of drugs such as methamphetamine, cocaine and fentanyl into the United States of America in February 2026. The election of Donald J Trump and his mass deportation policy also led to a strain in relations with Mexico with the president, Claudia Sheinbaum, announcing that Mexico will seek investigation in the US related to the deaths of 17 Mexican nationals during immigration enforcement operations or at detention centers. The United States of America also collaborates with Guatemala to combat drug trafficking, furthermore they are their biggest trade partner as well as collaborate with them providing help to Guatemala on numerous occasions such as the PRM (The Department of State's Bureau of Population, Refugees, and Migration) giving over 30 mln dollars in humanitarian assistance to vulnerable migrants, asylum seekers and refugees to Guatemala in 2023 or the INL (The Department of State's Bureau for International Narcotics and Law Enforcement Affairs) providing assistance to the Guatemalan Government.

Russian Federation

The Russian Federation is the biggest country, with the highest amount of nuclear weapons. Remains actively involved in the war with Ukraine, started by the Russians in 2022. Russia recently intensified its military attacks in Ukraine, being even more deadly for civilians. Additionally Russia is accused by European countries of conducting a series of sabotages across Europe. The Prime minister of Germany has stated that Russia is responsible for the drones containing explosives, which were found at Leipzig's airport, which is used by Ukraine to transport military goods. As a response Vladimir Putin demands proof and calls the situation absurd. At the same time the Milrem robotics factory in Estonia, which supplies drones to Ukraine, went up in flames, and the Estonian Prime Minister stated that the possibility that it is Russia's sabotage, is being taken very seriously. Latin America is where Russia's closest allies are Brasil, Nicaragua and Cuba. Russia is the biggest supplier of fertilizer to Brazil supplying them with 45.5 million tonnes of fertilisers in 2025 and the countries share close trade ties as members of BRICS. Furthermore, on February 5th 2026 both countries had decided to adopt additional measures to expand trade, attract investment and develop joint projects in areas such as energy, industry, agriculture, high technology, science, culture and space exploration. When it comes to Nicaragua Russia had signed the Federal Law „On the Ratification of the Agreement on Military Cooperation between the Government of the Russian Federation and the Government of the Republic of Nicaragua” and the „Agreement

between the Russian Federation and the Republic of Nicaragua on the Mutual Protection of Citizens Against Abuses in the Field of International Justice” in 2026, which tightened the countries’ relations. Last but not least, Cuba is a country where Russia is testing non-Western payment infrastructure and positioning the island as a regional hub for importing Russian information technology and digital solutions into Latin America.

Nicaragua

The Republic of Nicaragua, known as the largest of Central American Republics is also one of Latin America's poorest countries having an average salary of 18 000 US dollars annually.

Although Nicaragua had been known as one of the least violent countries of latin america, their presidents Daniel Orteza and Rosario Mullilo had been called out by the Human Rights Council for financing the oppression of their opponents through the illegal diversion of public funds. On 20 July 2026 the president Daniel Orteza abolished the electoral system in order to maintain his rule over the country, as well as to delegitimize opposition. The same presidents intensified repression of religious institutions as well as violent oppressions of protests. One of Nicaragua's closest allies is China with whom they signed eleven loans between 2023 and 2025, are economic partners and send 400 policemen each year to the PRC for training.

Another Nicaraguan ally is Russia, with whom Nicaragua had signed the Federal Law „On the Ratification of the Agreement on Military Cooperation between the Government of the Russian Federation and the Government of the Republic of Nicaragua” and the „Agreement between the Russian Federation and the Republic of Nicaragua on the Mutual Protection of Citizens Against Abuses in the Field of International Justice” in 2026.

Nicaragua has also quite a complicated relationship with the USA, their biggest economic partner, who condemns Ortega's abolishment of the electoral system and supports civil society organisations, independent media and human rights defenders in Nicaragua.

Useful links:

<https://2021-2025.state.gov/u-s-relations-with-nicaragua/>

Mexico

The United Mexican States reached a record low working poverty percentage in the first quarter of 2026 of 30.7%. Furthermore Mexico is still struggling with cartel violence and drug trafficking, but under president Claudia Sheinbaum the situation seems to be improving as the daily murder rate dropped by 37 percent between September 2024 and the end of 2025. Furthermore, in February 2026 Mexican security with the help of US intelligence forces killed Nemesio Rubén Oseguera Cervantes, known also as „El Mencho”, the leader of the most powerful Mexican trafficking organisations, Jalisco New Generation Cartel, responsible for distributing a big amount of drugs such as methamphetamine, cocaine and fentanyl into the United States of America. This operation was one of the biggest disruption to drug trafficking since the 80'. Despite this successful collaboration the relationship between The United Mexican States and The United States of America are worsening with the Mexican president, Claudia Sheinbaum seeking investigation into the death of 17 Mexicans and not accepting US forces participating in operations on Mexican territory which was met with a threat that the US could go alone if they feel that Mexico is not doing enough.

When it comes to Mexico's allies they have recently created a binational plan for 2027 with Guatemala, which contains five pillars: shared security, border and connectivity, technical and scientific cooperation, human mobility with dignity and development of opportunities.

But Guatemala is not the only country with whom Mexico shares a plan, another one is Canada, one of their closest allies, with whom they made an Canada-Mexico Action Plan for 2025-2028 which is structured around four strategic pillars— Prosperity; Mobility, Inclusivity and Well-being; Security; and Environment and Sustainability—reflecting the shared priorities that will shape a forward-looking, resilient, and dynamic bilateral relationship.

Useful links:

<https://english.elpais.com/international/2026-05-07/hondurasgate-the-alleged-us-and-israeli-interference-plot-to-destabilize-mexico-and-other-progressive-governments.html>

https://theowp.org/crisis_index/mexican-drug-war-2/

India

Due to border tensions The Republic of India increased their focus on militarisation, declaring in June 2026 to spend two billion dollars on military drones from domestic manufacturers. In the same month they also approved the purchase of military equipment for its defence forces worth 5,46 billion dollars. India recently adopted a new policy which allows its private sector to produce advanced weaponry in an attempt to achieve military self-sufficiency. At the same time the country is trying to diversify their foreign suppliers of weapons, trying to move away from its longstanding reliance on Russia, expanding defence ties with Israel, France and the USA. India's relationship with Russia may have worsened this year, because Russia killed four Indian seafarers in a missile strike on a merchant vessel near Ukraine, which was called „unacceptable” by the Indian Ministry of External Affairs. India's relationship with Russia, even after they attacked Ukraine, is still pretty good. Vladimir Putin even met with the Prime Minister of India in 2025 and they agreed to: improve defence and energy partnerships, increase nuclear and outer space cooperation, enhance economic and trade ties and reinforce transport and connectivity. Another important country for India is the US, their biggest trading partner, with whom they signed, in May 2026, a bilateral Critical Mineral Framework, to ensure that the foundational elements required for advanced technology and energy are available within trusted networks. The relation between India and Russia's biggest ally, is on the other hand way different, and more complex. Although China and India had peaceful relations for thousands of years, their relationship worsened when in 1949 the communist party took over China and when China annexated Tibet. In 2020 they had a border clash leaving 11 soldiers injured, which led to India boycotting Chinese brands. Later on they tried to rekindle their relationships, as both of them are members of BRICS, In 2025 the Chinese and Indian Defence Ministers met calling for a permanent end of border disputes. Despite the diplomatic efforts both countries found themselves in yet another border dispute in 2026 regarding China denying the Indian army access to key patrolling points, while slowly taking. Over the Indian border of Arunachal Pradesh, sparking a political outrage. Furthermore India refused to renew the 1960 water pact with Pakistan which has a strong bond with China, on which shared rivers fed 80% of Pakistan's agricultural land. India has also increasingly strengthened their relationship with Latin America, increasing trade by nearly 2000 percent in the last 21 years, their key partners being Brasil, Argentina and Mexico.

Guatemala

The Republic of Guatemala struggles financially, having more than half of their population (56%) living in poverty, even though they have the largest economy in Central America. Furthermore, The Republic of Guatemala has one of the highest crime indexes and a homicide rate of 16.8 per 100,000 people, (for comparison the global average homicide rate was 5.61 per 100,000 for 2022). Having difficulties with combating cartel violence, as well as drug-trafficking the president, Bernardo Arevalo requested US military cooperation against drug trafficking.

The US is also the biggest economical partner of Guatemala, being their largest trade partner. The US also provided help to Guatemala on numerous occasions such as the PRM (The Department of State's Bureau of Population, Refugees, and Migration) giving over 30 mln dollars in humanitarian assistance to vulnerable migrants, asylum seekers and refugees to Guatemala in 2023 or the INL (The Department of State's Bureau for International Narcotics and Law Enforcement Affairs) providing assistance to the Guatemalan Government.

The Republic of Guatemala is also one of Taiwan's oldest allies, from 1933, being one of the 12 formal allies of Taiwan. The previous president of Guatemala, Alejandro Giammattei even stated that Taiwan is „the one and only true China”, while the current president, Bernardo Arevalo publicly referred to Taiwan as the Republic of China, reaffirming his support to Taiwan as an independent state. Those actions lead to The PRS, who despite the lack of diplomatic relations with Guatemala has been successful in spreading its economical and even political influence across Guatemala, pressuring Guatemala to abandon Taiwan.

Another ally of Guatemala is Mexico with whom they recently created a binational plan for 2027 containing five pillars: shared security, border and connectivity, technical and scientific cooperation, human mobility with dignity and development of opportunities.

Useful links: <https://en.unav.edu/web/global-affairs/detalle/-/blogs/comienza-la-recta-final-del-diferendo-territorial-entre-guatemala-y-belice-3>
https://theowp.org/crisis_index/central-american-migration-crisis/

French Guiana

French Guiana is an overseas region of France, so its major political decisions are made by the French government rather than by themselves. Illegal gold mining remains a serious problem, due to its impact on the environment and is linked to organized criminalists in particular. France continues to fight against illegal mining and maintains a significant amount of military and gendarmerie in the territory. French Guiana is also strategically important because in Kourou there is Europe's main spaceport, located in a place that provides benefits for launching spacecraft into low-inclination or geostationary earth orbits. French Guiana maintains close relations, mainly based on peace keeping by NATO and Lancaster house treaties agreement, signed in 2010. France and Russia have tense relations due to Russia's war in Ukraine, with France supporting Ukraine, EU sanctions and stronger European defence, while Russia opposes its position. French Guiana maintains close relations with Brazil in cross-border mobility including significant trade, cultural exchange, and migration between Oiapoque and French Guiana's coastal cities like Cayenne. Local political movements continue to advocate that Paris should give French Guiana more control over its own affairs. Movements like Parti Progressiste Démocratique have long pushed sovereignty, arguing that economic disparities and disparities are direct results of colonial policies, therefore supporting greater autonomy.

Useful links: <https://www.britannica.com/place/French-Guiana/Government-and-society>

United Kingdom

In the year ending June 2026, the number of asylum modules fell by 21% and the number of boat crossings across the English Channel fell by about 23%. The number of people accommodated in hotels for asylum seekers fell to around 16,000, slowly moving the UK away from the migration crisis. In 2026 May 7 in which Andy Burnham was elected. During his ruling some controversial financial decisions have been implemented, like investing in defenses while simultaneously facing significant domestic spending pressures. There is currently a reported £4.7 billion gap in the Defence Investment Plan, while social care and other domestic programmes also require additional funding. The UK has a complicated relationship with China as it is

a major economic partner, but those two countries disagree over human rights as UK openly criticizes China over issues such as political freedoms, treatment of activist and restrictions on expansion, which china rejects..Uk and Panama maintain a friendly relationship, because of panama canal which brings stability and security for shipping routes to Britain UK maintains generally supportive relations with Caribbean countries, especially Jamaica and Belize, as those countries are a part of common wealth and Britain still remains a strong economic partner. US-UK security relationship is one of Britain's most important strategic assets as those two countries cooperate closely on defense, intelligence, nuclear security and foreign policy, for eg through Five Eyes, the US and UK exchange intelligence that can help identify terrorist threats, organizations and planned attacks. On the other hand , disagreements arise when the UK initially hesitates to let the US use UK military bases for direct strikes against Iran. Moreover, the UK prioritized Ukraine has become one of the UK's most important foreign-policy issues, making relations between the UK and Russia highly tense because of the war, sanctions and wider security concerns.

Useful links:

<https://www.reuters.com/world/uk/burnhams-summer-reprieve-gives-way-reckoning-over-his-spending-plans-2026-08-27/?\>

Honduras

Honduras is the second biggest country in Central America, after Nicaragua, and is also the second poorest country in Central America. Around 60 percent of the country's population is living in poverty with 38 percent living in extreme poverty. Honduras is also located along one of the busiest drug trafficking routes. Due to this fact foreign criminal groups have a strong presence in Honduras, primarily in human and drug trafficking. Those foreign criminal groups often come from the north, from Mexico, or from the south, from Colombia. Due to high rates of whide-spread criminal activity Honduras has the second biggest homicide rate in the Americas.

When it comes to international affairs Honduras's biggest trading partner is the US, to which goes almost 50% of their exports. The US is one of the biggest allies of Honduras, and provided them (the USAID and the Department of State) 785.05 million dollars in bilateral, regional, centrally managed, and humanitarian assistance. Although president Trump stressed about cooperation against drug cartels with the newly elected president of Honduras, he was also the one to pardon

Honduras's ex-president, Juan Orlando Hernández. The previous president of Honduras was sentenced to 45 years in prison, as he was a key figure in a drug trafficking scheme which flooded the US with 400 tonnes of cocaine, as well as accepting a 1 billion dollar bribe from notorious drug lord "El Chapo" in exchange for protecting drug trafficking routes through Honduras. Instead serving those 45 years he was let out by Trump after serving 19 months, additionally Trump said that this conviction was "a Biden setup".

The US also supported the strengthening of crossborder security between Honduras and Guatemala. The border between Honduras and Guatemala is part of a broader corridor which is used by transnational criminal organisations to traffic illegal goods, such as drugs to North America. That means intensified criminal activity in that region, which recently led to the killing of at least 24 people in North Honduras, and days later to those incidents the Guatemalan military personnel repelled an invasion of heavily armed individuals who illegally entered the country. Due to those incidents, military leaders were motivated to strengthen bilateral coordination on information sharing and border surveillance against transnational criminal organizations. In July Guatemala and Honduras also reactivated their High-Level Security and Justice Group to enhance political, technical, and operational coordination on security and justice issues between the two nations. The US also provided support to both countries through separate bilateral partnerships, helping Honduras with drug trafficking and organised crime investigations, having Honduras cooperating with the Drug Enforcement Administration.

Costa Rica

Costa Rica is a democratic state which holds relatively strong institutions such as: The Supreme Court (Corte Suprema de Justicia), The Supreme Electoral Tribunal (TSE), and The Legislative Assembly. The government of Costa Rica prioritizes welfare, stability, national security, as well as peace. Therefore, there is no standing army in this country (specially trained police - Public Force of Costa Rica takes its place). Costa Rica places greater importance on police, intelligence, border control and international cooperation. It is particularly necessary, as Costa Rica is facing a severe surge in drug-related crime and violence as it serves as a major transit hub for international cocaine shipments.

Costa Rican economy focuses on: tourism, agriculture, services and exports.

Moreover, the country maintains strong economic ties with the US and Central America. Alongside the USA, Costa Rica fights with organised crime and drug trafficking. Furthermore, the two countries share migration policies and collaborate to manage regional security. However, it shares interests with China and major European states. Additionally, Costa Rica historically has been a destination and transit country for migrants in Central America.

Within the Central American region, Costa Rica is strongly cooperating with Guatemala, Honduras, Panama and Mexico, as Costa Rica is a member of SICA and OAS and an active participant of the UN.

Costa Rica attaches great importance to healthcare and international healthcare cooperation, so there is a relatively developed public healthcare system.

Useful links:

<https://www.unesco.org/en/memory-world/abolition-army-costa-rica>

https://adscientificindex.com/all-institutions-rankings/?ft_country=123

<https://www.oecd.org/en/topics/sub-issues/economic-surveys/costa-rica-economic-snapshot.html>

Brazil

Brazil is turning to judicial measures to combat illegal gold mining in the Amazon, a persistent threat to the rainforest. These efforts often focus on indigenous groups and local communities, which has only heightened existing tensions. The struggle to protect the Amazon and uphold Indigenous rights continues to be a major issue within the country, as environmental concerns clash with the interests of agriculture, mining, and economic development. Tensions with the US over tariffs have become an important recent issue. Internally, the Supreme Court, Congress and the executive branch all have significant influence, creating frequent political conflicts, as the president of Brazil often wants to introduce a law that congress doesn't pass making the president use an executive authority for e.g. trumps action on the US-Mexico border. Brazil and Colombia maintain the strongest relation as both of those countries maintain active cooperation on protecting Amazon, security and global diplomacy. Brazil and Haiti have significant historical relationships because Brazil led the UN peacekeeping mission in Haiti (MINUSTAH). Nowadays cooperation focuses mainly on humanitarian aid, migration and disaster response.

The Ashaninka Indigenous people, who reclaimed their territory on the Brazil-Peru border decades ago, now face threats from gangs and drug traffickers, as it lays on Solimoes River route, which is a key crossing in water drugs trafficking to Brazil and then further. Ashanika leaders asked for protection which had been provided however not fully as it is not present all the time. In Brazil there are currently ongoing general presidential elections that will take place on October 4th 2026.

Colombia

Total peace modifies the public law order and allows for the government to negotiate with armed and criminal groups using different strategies and legal tools. This law has had mixed results, with some ceasefires and negotiations but continued violence involving groups such as the ELN and dissident FARC factions. In 2026, security remains one of Colombia's main domestic problems, particularly in rural areas where armed groups compete for territory and control of illegal economies. Colombia and Russia maintain an economic and diplomatic relations mainly based on cacao trade and energy transfer. Colombia has also faced tensions with the United States, especially over migration, deportations and drug policy, although both countries remain important partners. Furthermore Colombia also maintains a complicated relation with Venezuela as millions of migrants moved from Venezuela invading Colombian international security. The government continues to emphasise the protection of the Amazon and Indigenous communities, while balancing environmental policies with Colombia's dependence on oil, coal and other natural resources.

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